



Microsoft is helping schools

Microsoft is helping the school with Windows 10 by revealing Windows 10 and Office's Classroom focused features. <http://dgit.in/MicFocSchool>



Windows keypad on iPhone

Microsoft just announced it's Windows Phone Keyboard for iOS devices which will help users to swipe or tap to text. <http://dgit.in/WinKeyios>

Bazaar

ASUS ZenBook UX303UB

Combines elegance with good performance

It's never been only about the looks as far as the ASUS ZenBook's concerned and the UX303UB stays true to that principle. The 13-inch ZenBook's dressed in an all metal exterior, leaving no doubt in anyone's mind that it's a premium notebook. Its signature design element, the spun metal concentric circles are a striking feature of the ZenBook UX303UB, one that definitely heightens the overall aesthetics of the ultrabook.

While the ultrabook weighs 1.45 kg, the notebook doesn't really feel sleek and light when you try to hold it. Unlike the ASUS ZenBook UX305FA and UX305LA that we tested last year, which had tapering edges and shrunk in size along its breadth from the hinge to the front lip, this ZenBook UX303UB feels a bit bulky and chunky, which is a bit of a shame as it takes away from the overall aura of the notebook. Having said that, the ZenBook is quite well built, with a sturdy hinge that holds the screen and the rest of the chassis in place very well.

The ASUS ZenBook UX303UB continues to house an isolated keyboard with chiclet-style keys that are great to type on, no problem whatsoever. The UX303UB's keyboard deck features a nice wide palm rest that's convenient for parking most wrists on it without a hitch. The wide palm rest also houses a large single slab trackpad which has a fine matte finish. The trackpad houses left and right clickable mouse button zones which is great.

In terms of the ZenBook UX303UB's overall performance, it definitely ranks higher than last year's ASUS ZenBook UX305LA and UX305FA, respectively. While both these ZenBooks came with fast-paced SSD storage and oodles of RAM packed into their diminutive shells, the ZenBook UX303UB drops the SSD for a regular spinning hard drive. However, it does better than the previous two ZenBooks in the CPU and GPU department, packing in the latest generation 2.3 GHz Intel Core i5-6200U chip that supports Turbo Boost speeds of up to 2.8GHz under heavy load and NVIDIA GeForce GT 940M graphics with discrete 2GB of GDDR3 memory for some much needed performance chops.

As a result, we found out that the ASUS ZenBook UX303UB is easily one of the fastest ultrabook we've reviewed this year, with PC Mark 8 Creative Score of 3521 and 3D Mark Ice Storm Extreme and Cloud Gate scores of 42,326 and 5,895, respectively.



Price
₹71,490

The ZenBook UX303UB's Full HD 1080p screen isn't glossy and doesn't attract fingerprints. The screen's quite bright and offers decent contrast levels. Both watching HD movies and reading large chunks of texts is handled well on the ZenBook UX303UB's LED-backlit 13.3-inch screen panel. It isn't an IPS panel, though, which means discernible colour shift when you view the screen from acute angles. The ZenBook offers ASUS's SonicMaster audio with Bang and Olufsen technology. Audio output from the notebook was decent and the sound was largely clear and distortion free up to the 70% volume.

The one area where the ZenBook UX303UB disappoints is in its battery output. Its 3-cell battery only lasted for 3 hours 26 minutes in our high performance battery test. This number is shorter than all the other ultrabooks we tested recently, including the ZenBook UX305LA, UX305FA and Dell XPS 13 which clocked just under 6 hours – easily the best of the lot.

In terms of features and connectivity, the ASUS ZenBook UX303UB tries to pack in all the essentials. It also comes with an ambient light sensor to dynamically alter the laptop's screen brightness.

The ASUS ZenBook UX303UB definitely raises the bar in terms of what a ZenBook can offer in terms of performance. It does so while keeping its premium elegance and great looks. It does has its low moments, especially in its bulk and battery life, but nothing that upsets the overall appeal. If you can afford its ₹71k price, this is a good notebook.

Jayesh Shinde



Features.....	66
Design.....	70
Performance.....	70
Value.....	90

Specifications

CPU: Intel® Core™ i5-6200U Processor, 2.3GHz (3M Cache, up to 2.8GHz); **OS:** Windows 10 (64bit); **RAM:** 4GB; **HDD:** 1TB 5400RPM; **Display:** 13.3-inch, Full HD resolution; **GPU:** NVIDIA GeForce 940M 2GB GDDR3 + Intel HD 520; **Weight:** 1.45 kg (with 3 cell battery); **Battery:** 50WHrs, 3SIP, 3-cell Li-ion Polymer Battery Pack; **Keyboard type:** Illuminated Chiclet Keyboard; **Supplied Accessories:** Sleeve & cable

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